Expressing cause and result

Goal: To link two ideas by showing which one is the cause and which one is the result, using connectors such as *because*, *since*, *as*, *so*, *therefore* and *as a result*, especially when talking about the life of a famous figure.

The idea in two lines: A cause answers the question *Why?*; a result answers the question *What happened then?*. Some connectors introduce the cause (because, since, as, because of), and others introduce the result (so, therefore, that is why, as a result).

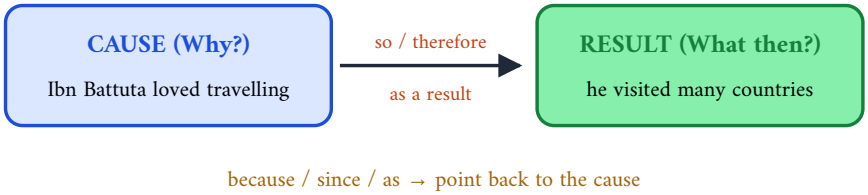


Figure 1: The cause comes first in time; result connectors point forward, cause connectors point back.

🔵 Rules and concepts

1. **because** / **since** / **as** + a full clause (subject + verb) introduce the **cause**: *She became famous because she wrote great novels.*
2. **because of** / **due to** / **thanks to** + a noun or noun phrase (no verb): *He succeeded thanks to his hard work.* Use *thanks to* only for positive causes.
3. **so** introduces the **result** and joins two clauses with a comma: *He trained every day, so he won the race.*
4. **therefore** / **consequently** / **as a result** / **that is why** usually start a new sentence and are followed by a comma: *He trained every day. Therefore, he won the race.*
5. The cause clause can come first or second. When it comes first, add a comma: *Because he was curious, he read a lot.*

6. Use one connector per link: *because … so* together is wrong.
7. Test: the clause that answers **Why?** is the cause.

🟢 Examples

1. Join: *Avicenna studied medicine. He wrote The Canon of Medicine.* **Solution:** Avicenna studied medicine, **so** he wrote The Canon of Medicine. / Avicenna wrote The Canon of Medicine **because** he had studied medicine.
2. Rewrite with *because of*: *The match was cancelled because it rained heavily.* **Solution:** The match was cancelled **because of** the heavy rain. **Explanation:** *because of* needs a noun phrase, so *rained* becomes *rain*.
3. Rewrite with *therefore*: *Since Mouloud Feraoun loved his village, he described it in his books.* **Solution:** Mouloud Feraoun loved his village. **Therefore**, he described it in his books.

🟠 Common BEM mistakes

- Writing *because of* + clause: *because of he was ill* ✗ → *because he was ill* ✓ or *because of his illness* ✓.
- Putting the result after *because*: the clause after *because* must always be the cause.
- Forgetting the comma before *so* and after *Therefore*.
- Using *thanks to* for a negative cause: *He failed thanks to laziness* ✗ → *because of* ✓.

🟡 Quick review

- Cause connectors: because, since, as (+ clause); because of, due to, thanks to (+ noun).
- Result connectors: so, therefore, consequently, as a result, that is why.
- One connector per link: never *because … so*.
- Comma before *so*; comma after *Therefore* / *As a result*.
- Ask *Why?* to find the cause, *What then?* to find the result.

madrasadz.com مدرسة ديزاد